meesho SEASON 3

DICE CHALLENGE

BUSINESS TRACK · MONETIZATION CASE

FINDING NEW WAYS FOR MEESHO TO EARN

The Bharat Trial Network

Closing the feedback loop on product sampling in Bharat · "Pehle Try, Phir Buy"

Brands pay to put samples in Bharat's hands and **learn nothing back**: no identity, no response, no purchase signal. Meesho sells them the **closed loop**: a sample in a chosen household's parcel, her answer within a week, her purchase at 90 days.

₹650 Cr run-rate by end-FY28 ≈ 1% of NMV · Seller Pays ₹0 · Buyer Pays ₹0.

TEAM

Moshi Moshi



Mukund Singhal
TEAM LEADER



Vaibhav Itauriya
TEAM MEMBER



Karmanya Goyal
TEAM MEMBER

Executive Summary

WHAT IT IS WORTH · THE PROBLEM THAT BLOCKS IT · HOW WE UNBLOCK IT



SO WHAT Brands spend **~₹5,400 Cr a year** sampling and testing new products in India and learn almost nothing back. Meesho can sell the missing feedback loop: **a ₹650 Cr run-rate by end-FY28 ≈ 1% of NMV**, at **60% lower cost per product launch**, with zero commission untouched.

WHAT IT IS WORTH → WHAT BLOCKS IT → HOW WE UNBLOCK IT

↺ Every answer re-targets the next campaign: the loop compounds

① WHAT IT IS WORTH

EXIT-FY28 RUN-RATE

₹650 Cr

≈ 1% of FY28 NMV
(**₹65,000** Cr at **25%** CAGR)

500 Mn closed-loop trials × ₹13 blended price · **₹6.63** contribution per trial (51%) · **₹800 Cr in FY29 (0.99% NMV)**

Triangulated three independent ways	FY28
Demand: category trial & testing spend → SAM × 15%	₹608 Cr
Users: 331 Mn ATU × 50% opted-in × 3 trials × ₹13	₹646 Cr
Supply: 4.5 Bn parcels × 11% carry a trial × ₹13	₹644 Cr

② THE PROBLEM THAT BLOCKS IT

THE FEEDBACK GAP

Brands pay to sample Bharat, and learn nothing back.

- A promoter hands over a sachet; the brand gets a **count sheet**: no identity, no response, no purchase signal.
- **Coverage misses the target bucket**: Tier 1-2 get promoters; Tier 3-4 stay unserved because cost per contact (₹25-40) stays high.
- Launch volume is up **1.8×**, yet only **4%** of FMCG launches reach 1% penetration (NIQ): brands are launching blind.

Brand voice: "Har quarter sampling budget banta hai par hisaab nahi milta."
~ hair & cosmetics manufacturer

③ HOW WE UNBLOCK IT

CLOSED-LOOP TRIAL

The sample rides a Meesho parcel; the answer rides back.

TARGET	TRIAL	RESPOND	PROVE	LEARN
5-dimension spend segment	Valmo hub inserts sachet	QR · 3 Ques ₹15 coupon	90-day buy vs holdout	brand dashboard

Brand pays ₹9-16 per delivered trial from its BTL budget · **Seller** pays ₹0, untouched
Buyer gets a free product + ₹15 coupon, opt-in only.

60%	200×	₹108
cheaper per launch	more feedback	per verified answer

WHO IS ALLOWED TO PAY?

1% FY26 NMV = ₹416 Cr

EVERY MEESHO SELLER
₹416 Cr ÷ 5.75 L
₹7,200
= 1.24% of a ₹5.8 L seller's NMV
→ **a commission renamed**

EVERY BUYER / YEAR
₹416 Cr ÷ 264 Mn
₹16
only if it isn't the price of goods
→ **hurts affordability**

EVERY PARCEL
₹416 Cr ÷ 2.67 Bn
₹1.56
anything worth ₹2 a parcel clears the bar

A BRAND OUTSIDE MEESHO
₹416 Cr ÷ ~1,000 campaigns
₹42 L
a single launch's sampling line
→ **open door**

Zero commission is a mathematical constraint on who the customer may be. The only payer who clears it without touching seller fees or buyer prices is a brand buying something Meesho uniquely has: **a parcel already at the door, and a way to hear back.**

THE BRIEF, ANSWERED IN ONE LINE EACH

Reader's Guide

The question	Our answer
What unmet need?	Brands sample Bharat but get **no feedback**: no identity, response or purchase signal and Tier 3-4 barely reached
Is it real? Who did we ask?	62 buyers surveyed, 4 recorded interviews (buyers, brand, seller): 79% welcome a sample, 84% would answer
How big is it?	**₹5,378 Cr** of trial & testing spend in 7 categories → **₹608-646 Cr ≈ 1% of NMV**, cross-checked 3 ways
What is offered, how does it earn?	Closed-loop trial sold to brands at **₹9 / ₹13 / ₹16** per delivered trial: **Seller and Buyer pay ₹0**
Can it physically run?	Brand-funded inbound, 5 costed packing options on trial, and **flag-the-order** matching at the hub
What does it deliver?	**60% cheaper per product launch**, 200× the feedback, ₹6.63 contribution per trial
Who pays, and does it pay back?	FMCG, D2C & SME brands; ₹19 Cr peak investment, payback by month 13, ~1% NMV from FY29
What isn't solved yet?	5 gaps priced (₹410 Cr at stake), returns modelled both ways, guardrails for buyers & sellers
How do we test it?	₹46 L, 90-day pilot in Eastern UP & Bihar, with a kill line at every gate

THE DEAL FOR EVERY STAKEHOLDER

Value Exchange



BRAND (payer): gives ₹13/trial from BTL budget · gets a chosen household, her answer in 7 days, her purchase at 90 days. **60% cheaper per launch.**



BUYER: gives 3 answers, opt-in · gets a free product she'd never be offered + ₹15 off next order. **Pays ₹0.**



SELLER: gives nothing; sample weight never billed to his slab. Phase 2: earns ₹3 a parcel for inserting. **Pays ₹0.**

MEESHO: keeps ₹6.63/trial, new budget pool (BTL), India's largest opted-in feedback panel; ~₹0.73/parcel to reinvest in shipping subsidy.

Money moves one way: Brand → Meesho. Seller and Buyer never pay; the buyer is the only party who receives something for free.

THE THESIS IN ONE LINE Meesho walks into **264 million Bharat homes 2.67 billion times a year** and uses that moment only to hand over a box. Brands spend ~₹5,400 Cr a year trying to put a product in those hands **and still cannot hear back.** Meesho can sell them both halves.

Sources: Meesho FY26 annual report & investor material (NMV, orders, ATU, contribution); NielsenIQ India FMCG launch tracker (yr to May 2025); Team Survey n=62, 4 full interviews; Full calculations and assumption register in Appendix.

The Problem: No Feedback Loop

BRANDS PAY TO PUT A PRODUCT IN BHARAT'S HAND, AND HEAR NOTHING BACK



SO WHAT **The feedback loop does not exist.** A promoter hands a sachet to a household and the brand learns nothing, not who got it, not whether she liked it, not whether she bought. And the households brands most want to learn from, **Tier 3 and 4, are the ones they reach least.**

TODAY'S SAMPLING JOURNEY · A ONE-WAY STREET

Journey Map - One ₹1.6 Cr Launch, 5 Lakh Sachets

	1 · PLAN Brand Team	2 · BOOK BTL Agency	3 · HAND OUT Promoter at Haat /Mall	4 · TRY Household	5 · LEARN? Brand Team
WHAT HAPPENS	Activation manager gets a launch line from BTL budget; picks **districts**, not people	Agency books promoter-days where footfall is highest: malls, mandis, melas	Sachet handed to whoever walks past; promoter fills a **count sheet**	Uses it (or not). Nobody asks what she thought. Her name is never known	Waits 3 - 6 months for district sales; cannot separate sampling from TV, price, season
₹ SPENT	₹1.6 Cr line	+10-15% fee	₹25-40 / contact	₹0 to her	₹2-3 L for a 300-person HUT
WHAT THE BRAND LEARNS	a budget	a location list	a headcount	nothing	a guess

BRAND CONFIDENCE emotion curve

"this launch will work" → "₹40 a contact in Tier-3?" → "did they reach our buyer?" → "no one knows who she is" → "worth it?"

THE BREAK The arrow from **step 4 back to step 1** does not exist. **No response · no identity · no purchase signal.** Every launch starts as blind as the last one, and the household that was sampled is never heard from again.

THE FEEDBACK GAP · NEED VS. WHAT EXISTS

Gap Analysis

What the brand needs to know	What it gets today	Status
Who received it (PIN, profile, spend)	A location and a headcount	✗ NONE
Did she use it / like it?	Never asked	✗ NONE
Did she buy the full size?	District sales, 3-6 months late, confounded	~ PROXY
Which segment converts best?	Unknowable: No Identity	✗ NONE
Why she didn't buy (price, smell, pack)?	A 300-person home-use test, metro-skewed, 6-8 weeks	~ TINY n
Can I reach her again?	No, the promoter moved on	✗ NONE

COST PER LEARNED HOUSEHOLD
₹54,000
₹1.62 Cr ÷ 300 HUT answers

SAMPLED HOUSEHOLDS HEARD FROM
0 of 5 L
0.00% response channel

CLAIMED CONVERSION
5 - 25%
survey-based, unmeasured

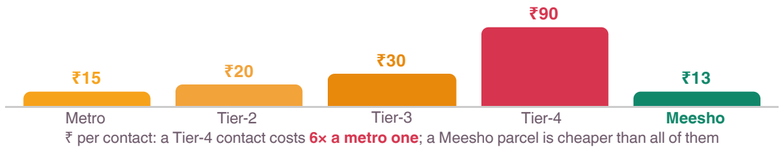
"In-store sampling is a **$2 Bn** channel in the US and **nobody agrees on how to measure it**", if the most mature market can't close the loop, Bharat's promoters certainly can't.

PROBLEM 2 · COVERAGE MISSES TIER 3-4

Promoter Day Economics

Cost per contact = **promoter-day cost ÷ footfall**.
The day costs the same everywhere; footfall does not. So the further from a metro, the dearer the contact: **exactly where brands want to grow.**

Where	₹ / promoter-day	contacts / day	₹ / contact
Metro mall (our costing)	3,000	200	15
Tier-2 market	3,000	150	20
Tier-3 haat (quote ₹28-32)	3,000	100	30
Tier-4 village + travel	3,600	40	90
Meesho parcel, any PIN	-	**already at door**	**13**



₹ per contact: a Tier-4 contact costs **6× a metro one**; a Meesho parcel is cheaper than all of them

ROOT CAUSE · 5 WHYS

Why can't the Brand hear back?

WHY 1 Why can't the brand tell if sampling worked? It never learns **who** got the sample.

WHY 2 Why doesn't it learn who? Promoters hand sachets to **passers-by**, not to named households.

WHY 3 Why passers-by? A promoter can only stand **where footfall is**, he can't pick a person, or come back to her.

WHY 4 Why can't anyone pick her and come back? That needs **a doorstep visit AND a relationship** with the household at the same time.

WHY 5 Why does no one have both? Delivery firms own the doorstep but not the customer and ad platforms own the customer but not the doorstep.

ROOT CAUSE → The loop needs one player with **a physical hand-over AND a re-contactable, consenting customer**. Meesho is the only one at Bharat scale: 2.67 Bn parcels a year, each tied to a known buyer and purchase history.

JOBS-TO-BE-DONE · THREE USERS

Who feels the gap

Activation Manager
"When I launch in Tier-3, I want to put the product in **the right** households and **know what they thought and bought**, so I can defend next quarter's budget."

Bharat Household
"When a new brand appears, I want to **try before I spend** my ₹120, without being tricked or spammed, and to say no if I don't want it."

Meesho Seller
"When I pack orders, I want **nothing that adds cost, weight or work** to my parcel, unless it pays me." → the reason the seller stays out of the chain.

WHY NOW

1.8×
FMCG launches YoY (NIQ)

4%
of launches reach 1% penetration

May '27
DPDP: data must be opt-in

₹0
of BTL spend reaches e-commerce

Sources: Team promoter cost build-up (5 promoters × 10 days, ₹1.5 L, ~10,000 contacts); Brand Interview (hair & cosmetics manufacturer); NielsenIQ India (launches 1.8×, 4% reach 1% penetration); In-Kluso Ground on US in-store sampling; DPDP Act 2023. Tier-2/4 footfall are team assumptions.

Voice of Bharat: Would They Pay?

4 RECORDED INTERVIEWS · 62 SURVEY RESPONSES · SECONDARY RESEARCH ON SAMPLING MODELS



SO WHAT Buyers want the sample (**79% positive**) and will answer for it (**84% would or might scan**). Their worries (leakage, unknown brands, "how did they know?") become design rules, not deal-breakers. The brand will pay at ₹13 and the seller pays nothing.

RESEARCH DESIGN — Methods & Coverage

- **62** buyer survey responses
- **4** in-depth interviews (recorded)
- **₹15** promoter cost build-up
- **15+** seconday sources

WHERE RESPONDENTS LIVE

Metro	37%
Smaller City	48%
Town	8%
Village	6%

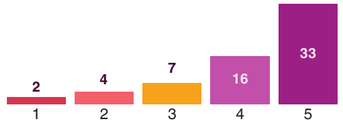
SHOPS ONLINE

Weekly	27%
Monthly	47%
Few / Yearly	19%
Rarely	6%

Interviews: 2 buyers, 1 Brand Sales Representative, 1 Seller.

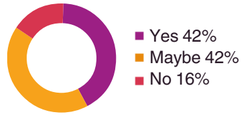
BUYER SURVEY · N = 62 — "a free sample arrives in your next order…"

HOW WOULD YOU FEEL? (1-5)



79% Positive (4-5)

SCAN QR FOR 3 QUES + COUPON?



84% Yes or Maybe (non-metro 85%)

IF YOU LIKED IT, BUY FULL SIZE?

Very Likely	15%
Somewhat	79%
Unlikely	6%

94% Would Consider: intent we must measure, not trust

WHAT WOULD WORRY YOU? (MULTI)

Unknown Product	40%
Leak / Spoil Clothes	39%
"How did they know?"	35%
Nothing	26%
Clutter / Waste	11%

SAMPLES YOU'D WELCOME (MULTI)

Food & Snacks	73%
Beauty & Personal	52%
Health & wellness	47%
Home & Cleaning	40%
None	5%

TRUST IN APP · OPT-OUT NEED

more 43%	*same* 49%	8
must 23%	*nice to have* 49%	*don't mind*

5× more say trust rises than falls
72% want a one-tap "No thanks".

Read Across: intent overstates behaviour, so we plan on **12% verified response** (42% "definitely" × 0.3), not 84%; pilot kill line **6%**.

PROOF PEOPLE WILL PAY — Willingness to Pay Matrix

Who	Pay / Join?	How much	Biggest concern
Brand Hair & Cosmetics Mfg.	YES · PILOT	₹13/trial vs ₹28 - 32 Tier-3 today	must get scan data + targeted household
Seller Blue Srk Clothing	JOINS	pays ₹0; paid ₹3 / insert (phase 2)	sample must not push parcel over 500 g slab
Buyer Survey (n = 62)	84% Y/M	pays ₹0; 3 Ques for a ₹15 coupon	leakage · unknown brand · privacy
Amazon US, 2019-20	PAID	$2 / sample, 25k minimum	closed: unsolicited surprise parcels
Peekage, Sampler Live Apps	PAYING	brands buy trial + closed-loop data	urban, opt-in panels only

Demand is proven and priced far above ours: Amazon charged ~₹170 a sample. What failed was the surprise parcel. Ours is **opt-in, disclosed at checkout, refusable at the door.**

Payment trigger: the brand's trade / activation manager already has a sampling line and we compete for an existing ₹ line, not a new one.

VOICE OF THE STAKEHOLDERS — Verbatims · Recordings · Survey Attached

BUYER: TRIAL & TRUST



"Market se naya brand jaldi nahi leta, paise waste hone ka darr rehta hai. Agar Meesho apne dabbe mein free sample bhejega, toh main try karne ka sochunga."

~ Kushagra Shukla

▶ Recording

BUYER: RISK & LEAKAGE



"Idea toh achha hai… koi extra delivery charge nahi hai, toh try karne mein kya nuksaan? Bas dhyaan rakhna sachet leak hoke kapde kharab na kare."

~ Vaishnavi Varshney

▶ Recording

BRAND: TARGETED SAMPLING



"Har quarter sampling budget banta hai par hisaab nahi milta. Tier-3 cost ₹28-32… ₹13 mein scan data aur targeted household mil jaye toh pilot ka budget ban jayega."

~ Sales Representative

▶ Recording

SELLER: OPERATIONS



"Har insert ka ₹3 mil raha hai toh ladkon ko bol dunga… par sample ka weight mila ke 500-gram slab cross na ho jaaye."

~ Blue Srk Clothing

▶ Recording

SURVEY OPEN-ENDS (VERBATIM)

"**Never give surprise free samples**. You may specify while buying 'this product comes with a free sample'."

"Would prefer if it is **tailored to the product choices I have**; a random product may annoy me."

"They **must mention that they themselves are sending** it so it doesn't feel suspicious."

INSIGHT → DESIGN RULE — Every worry becomes a spec

39% fear leakage on clothes	→	Leak-tested sealed sachet outside the seller's carton; creams/powders before oils
35% "how did they know?"	→	**Opt-in Free Sample Club**, checkout disclosure, targeting stays inside Meesho, cohort-only reports
40% distrust unknown products	→	Licensed brands only; "Meesho Trial Verified" seal; ingredients on the sachet
72% want a "No thanks"	→	One-tap opt-out in app + refuse at the door (rider hand-over)
"Tailored to my choices"	→	Segments on **spend behaviour**, never a random sachet
84% would / might scan	→	QR → 3 questions → ₹15 coupon; base case 12%, kill < 6%
94% would consider buying	→	90-day purchase read vs matched holdout: **measure, don't assume**
500 g seller's shipping slab	→	Sample weight billed to the campaign, never the seller

METRO VS NON-METRO — n = 23 · 39

	metro	non-metro
Feel positive about a sample	83	→ 77%
Would / might scan the QR	83	→ 85%
Trust the app more after it	30	→ 49%
Want beauty & personal care	43	→ 56%
Want food & snacks	65	→ 77%
Worry about leakage	35	→ 41%
See it as clutter / waste	0	→ 18%

So what: outside metros a sample **builds more trust** and beauty is wanted more: the case for leading with BPC in Tier 2 - 4. Those buyers are also pickier, so **relevance and leak-proofing matter more**.

Even among leak-worriers, 79% still feel positive.
Small samples: directional, re-measured in the pilot.

Primary: Google Form Survey, n=62 (Sep 2026; 63% non-metro); Recorded Interviews with 2 buyers, 1 Brand Sales Rep, 1 Meesho Seller. Secondary: Amazon Product Sampling (2019-20), Peekage, Sampler. Say-do discount of 0.3 is a team assumption tested at Day 30.

Rough Sizing: How Big Is It?

BOTTOM-UP FROM CATEGORY SPEND · TAM → SAM → SOM · TRIANGULATED THREE WAYS



SO WHAT Brands will spend **~₹7,370 Cr on product trial & testing in FY28**; ~₹4,050 Cr of it aims at non-metro homes Meesho already reaches. A 15% share is **₹608 Cr (0.94% NMV)**, and the user and parcel routes give ₹646 / ₹644 Cr, so **₹650 Cr ≈ 1% of NMV** sits at the top of a tight range.

STEP 1-3 · BOTTOM-UP FROM CATEGORY SPEND

FY25 ₹ Cr · sales → A&P → behind launches → on sampling & testing, + expansion trial

Category	① Sales	② A&P	A&P ₹	③ Launch 15%	④ S&T	Launch S&T	+ Expansion 3%	Pool		Sales source
Beauty & personal care	1,95,500	12%	23,460	3,519	25%	880	598	1,478		Redseer $23 Bn
Perfume & deodorant	10,000	12%	1,200	180	25%	45	31	76		BW Business
Snacks, biscuits, confec.	2,07,167	5%	10,358	1,554	20%	311	264	575		IMARC · IBEF
Other packaged food & bev. WIDENED	8,91,000	4%	35,640	5,346	20%	1,069	909	1,978		IMARC $129 Bn
Home care WIDENED	66,600	8%	5,328	799	20%	160	136	296		Euromonitor
Nutra & wellness WIDENED	75,900	15%	11,385	1,708	25%	427	290	717		IMARC $8.9 Bn
Baby care WIDENED	41,000	10%	4,100	615	25%	154	105	258		IMARC $4.8 Bn
TAM · trial & testing, FY25	**14,87,167**		**91,471**	**13,721**		**3,046**	**2,333**	**5,378**		**≈ 5.9% of A&P**

② A&P 4-15% filings: HUL 9.6%, Marico 11.2%, Emami ~20%, Britannia 3.1%, Tata Cons. 7.2%

③ Launch 15% launches = 3-7% of sales (Nestlé 7%, Dabur 3-5%) × 2-3× ad intensity

④ S&T 20-25% DTC brands put ~15% of all marketing into sampling

+ Expansion 3% launches alone = ₹3,046 Cr (0.53%): we widened the market, never the %s

STEP 4 · WHERE BRANDS SAMPLE TODAY, AND WHAT IT COSTS THEM

In-store promoter	Door-to-door crew	Haat / mela stall	Bundled in own pack	Home-use test agency	Meesho BTN
₹25-40 / contact	₹20-30 est.	₹30-90 / contact	₹2-5 est.	₹800 / respondent	₹13 / trial
✗ no feedback	✗ no feedback	✗ no feedback	~ own buyers only	✓ n ≈ 300	✓ 12% respond
Tier 3-4 low	urban only	seasonal	no new households	metro, 6-8 weeks	any PIN, 7 days

STEP 4-5 · TAM → SAM → SOM

FY28

TAM ₹7,368 Cr
₹5,378 Cr × 1.37 (11% category CAGR, 3 yrs)

SAM ₹4,052 Cr
× 55% aimed at non-metro households

SOM ₹608 Cr
× 15% Meesho share

≈ 0.94% NMV
FY28 NMV ₹65,000 Cr

Why 55%? Rural = 38% of FMCG sales (NIQ, 2025); add Tier-2/3 towns → ~55% of launch spend aims at non-metro buyers, Meesho's core.

Why 15%? Meesho holds ~16% of e-com retail media today; here it is 50%+ cheaper than incumbents.

At 10% share: ₹405 Cr = 0.62% NMV. Stated, not hidden.

WHERE "1% OF NMV = ₹650 CR" COMES FROM

FY26 contribution ₹2,060 Cr ÷ 4.95% × FY26 NMV ₹41,600 Cr × 1.25 ² × FY28 NMV ₹65,000 Cr × 1% = target ₹650 Cr

Not counted (upside): OTC & ayurveda, pet care, small appliances, and leg-two targeted reach that brands buy after they learn which segment converts.

Per ₹100 of beauty sales: ₹12 A&P → ₹1.80 on launches → ₹0.45 S&T, + ₹0.31 expansion trial = ₹0.76 → × 55% × 15% = **₹0.06 Meesho can address**.

CROSS-CHECK · THREE ROUTES, ONE ANSWER

FY28

① DEMAND · what brands spend — ₹608 Cr
Trial & testing pool ₹7,368 Cr × 55% non-metro × 15% share

② USERS · who can receive one — ₹646 Cr
331 Mn FY28 ATU (264 Mn × 12% p.a.) × **50% opt-in** (79% liked the idea; we halve it) × **3 trials / yr** (cap: 1 a month) × ₹13

③ SUPPLY · what parcels can carry — ₹644 Cr
4.5 Bn FY28 parcels × **11% carry a trial** (1 in 9) × ₹13 = 495 Mn trials

Three independent routes land within 6% of each other: demand, users and parcel capacity are not the binding constraint. **Brand adoption is**, which is what the pilot tests. Dashed line below = ₹650 Cr.





SENSITIVITY · WHERE IT BREAKS

₹ Cr, FY28

Parcels with a trial ↓ / price →	₹9 reach	₹13 blend	₹16 closed-loop
8% (1 in 12)	324	468	576
11% base (1 in 9)	446	644	792
14% (1 in 7)	567	819	1,008

≥ 1% NMV | 0.5-1% | < 0.5%

MEESHO SHARE OF SAM → REVENUE · DASHED = 1% NMV (₹650 CR)



The number to defend: if order-level matching fails, everything prices at ₹9 → **₹446 Cr (0.69%)**. Gap #1 on slide 09 is worth ~₹200 Cr.

Break-even fill rate for 1% NMV at ₹13 is **11.1%**, i.e. one sampled parcel in nine. Below 8% the idea is a ~0.7% business, still the largest new lever screened.

WHICH CATEGORY LEADS?

weighted scoring · ● = 5, ○ = 0

Criterion (weight)	BPC	Edible	Perfume	Wellness	Home	Baby
Trial pool size (25%)	◕	●	◔	◑	◑	◔
Launch frequency (15%)	◕	◑	●	◑	◑	◑
Sachet / format fit (15%)	●	◑	◑	◑	◕	◑
Buyer demand, survey (15%)	◑	●	◑	◕	◑	◑
Regulatory ease (15%)	◕	◑	◕	◑	◕	◑
Fit with Meesho buyer (15%)	●	◕	◕	◑	◑	◑
Weighted score	**4.15**	**3.80**	**3.10**	**3.00**	**2.90**	**2.05**

Lead with beauty & personal care: 27% of the pool, Bharat already buys it in ₹1-2 sachets, Cosmetics Rules allow "free sample, not for sale". **Edible is bigger (47%)** but needs FSSAI sample-label sign-off and shelf-life control, so it follows in phase 2; perfume rides with BPC.

Pilot · BPC | **FY28 · + Perfume, Home** | **FY29 · + Edible, Wellness, Baby**

Sales: Redseer (BPC $23 Bn), BW Businessworld (perfume & deo ₹10,000 Cr), IMARC/IBEF (packaged food $129 Bn, snacks, biscuits, confectionery, nutra, baby), Euromonitor (home ₹666 bn). A&P: company filings FY25. Launch share: Nestlé India, Dabur, Kantar. Rural share: NIQ 2025. ₹85/$.

The Solution: A Closed Feedback Loop

WHAT IS OFFERED · HOW IT EARNS · WHO PAYS FOR WHAT



SO WHAT Meesho sells brands a **closed-loop trial**: a sample in a chosen household's hand, her answer within days, and her purchase behaviour at 90 days, priced per delivered trial at **₹13** against ₹25-40 for a promoter contact that returns nothing.

HOW THE LOOP CLOSES, AND HOW THE MONEY MOVES

Five steps · ₹ on every arrow · the seller is never in the chain

1 · THE PAYER, NOT A MEESHO SELLER — TARGET

FMCG / D2C **brand books on a console**: spend segment, PIN clusters, quota, dates. Min 10,000 trials (₹1.3 L). **Ships sachets to one Valmo mother hub**, brand-funded (~₹0.25 / sample).

pays ₹13 / trial

₹13

2 · THE ENGINE: MEESHO + VALMO — FLAG & INSERT

At order creation the engine **flags matching order IDs** (opted-in only). Hub induction scan diverts flagged parcels; sachet goes in by **pouch, over-bag or rider**; a **pairing scan** ties sachet QR ↔ order ID.

seller untouched · ₹0

₹0

3 · THE HOUSEHOLD — TRY & RESPOND

Disclosed sample arrives with her order. She scans the QR or taps the in-app card → **3 questions → ₹15 off her next order** (Meesho-funded). Can refuse at the door or opt out in one tap.

free product + ₹15

free

4 · THE PROOF — PROVE AT 90 DAYS

Sampled cohort vs **matched holdout** (same segment, no sample): 90-day re-survey + Meesho purchase data → **incremental purchase lift**, not "intent". The loop no agency in India can close.

lift, not intent

data

5 · BACK TO THE PAYER — LEARN & RE-TARGET

Dashboard by segment: delivered, response %, rating, price acceptance, 90-day lift. **Cohort-only, min 5,000 households, never PII.** Next campaign re-targets the segment that converted.

data → next booking

↺ learning loop: every answer re-targets the next booking, so each loop is cheaper than the last

SEGMENT BUILDER · SPEND, NOT DEMOGRAPHICS

Illustrative

SEGMENT S-07 "Beauty switchers · E-UP & Bihar" — ■ S-07 range · I avg user

1	**Wallet share** — Meesho's share of her orders	≥ 60%	avg -
2	**Annual spend** — on Meesho	₹2,500 - 6,000	avg ₹1,580
3	**Avg order value**	₹200 - 400	avg ₹156
4	**Category spend** — beauty, not "lifestyle"	₹300 - 900 / yr	avg -
5	**Order frequency**	≥ 12 / yr	avg 10 / yr
+	**Geography · consent**	PIN clusters in E-UP & Bihar · **opted-in only**	

2.1 Mn matching households

5 L booked (24%) · ₹65 L at ₹13

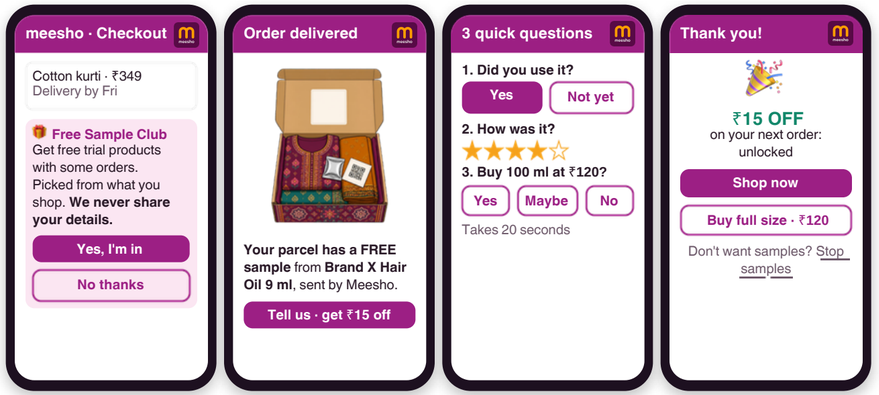
60k answers @ 12%

Why spend, not demographics: "Tier-3 woman, 25-40" says nothing about whether she buys the category. Spend rules show the brand exactly who it is buying.

Second sizing route: 2.1 Mn S-07 homes × ~₹600 beauty spend ≈ **₹126 Cr already on Meesho** in one segment; sampling all of them once costs a brand ₹2.7 Cr.

BUYER JOURNEY · "PEHLE TRY, PHIR BUY"

Prototype Screens



① Opt-in at checkout ② Disclosed sample ③ Respond (QR / app) ④ Reward + opt-out

Who pays the incentive? Meesho. ₹15 coupon × ~40% redemption × 12% responders = **₹0.72 per trial**. It buys a repeat order (₹156 NMV): a retention lever Meesho already pays for. The brand may add its own full-size offer to read purchase intent directly.

Meet Sunita, 31, Gorakhpur: ~1 Meesho order a month, ₹3,200 a year, so she is in S-07. Day 3: tries the sachet, answers. Day 90: in-app card "Bought it since?" vs holdout.

HOW IT EARNS · GOOD-BETTER-BEST

Per delivered trial

REACH	BASE TIER · SEGMENT	CLOSED-LOOP
₹9	₹13	₹16
PIN-cluster targeting · QR responses · delivered count	5-dimension spend segment · response, rating, price acceptance by segment	segment + 90-day lift vs holdout + re-target list
mix 25%	mix 50%	mix 25%

Blended ₹12.75 ≈ ₹13, sold as a media rate (CPT) to the brand or its agency: **no commission, no seller fee, no product price change.**

MVP SCOPE · MOSCOW

what ships in the 90-day pilot

✓ MUST
opt-in + disclosure · order flag + pairing scan · QR → 3 Qs → coupon · holdout · cohort report

◐ SHOULD
5-dimension segment builder · rider hand-over lane · brand dashboard v1

+ COULD
self-serve console · choose-your-sample menu · brand full-size offer

✕ WON'T (yet)
edible samples · seller-bench insertion · reach-ads upsell · **PII to brands: never**

Avg-user figures from Meesho FY26 (2.67 Bn orders, 264 Mn ATU, ₹156 NMV/order). Segment S-07 size and screens are illustrative (see prototype). Coupon economics: ₹15 × 40% redemption × 12% response = ₹0.72/trial.

Operations: Making It Work in the Hub

SAMPLES TO HUBS · SAMPLE INTO A SEALED PARCEL · SAMPLE TO THE RIGHT ORDER ID



SO WHAT We don't pick one packing method: **we trial three side by side** and let cost, buyer sentiment and shipping cost decide. And we never match samples to orders: **we flag orders for samples**, so "targeted" on the slide is "targeted" in the warehouse.

① GETTING SAMPLES TO THE HUBS

who funds it · costed

The brand funds inbound: it already pays to move samples to agencies and promoters today. Meesho bills it at cost.

Brand plant (5 L Sachets) → 1 FTL truck, 6 ton ~₹50k → **Valmo mother hub** (regional) → spare space on existing line-haul → **Spoke hubs** (+₹0.15 handling)

R1 · Direct	R2 · Mother hub CHOSEN	R3 · Brand depots
₹0.24	₹0.25	₹0.05-0.15
PTL courier to each hub; 20+ consignments a campaign	one truck, one receipt; scales to any hub count	large FMCG distributors drop on their own beat

- ₹1.25 L — inbound for a 5 L-trial campaign
- 1.9% — of the ₹65 L booking
- ₹0 — to Meesho or seller

Stock control: one campaign rack per hub · daily in = inserted + damaged + returned · variance > 1% pauses that hub · FEFO by expiry · leftovers go back to the brand.

② GETTING THE SAMPLE INTO A SEALED PARCEL · FIVE OPTIONS, COSTED

we pitch all, trial three, let the data pick

	A Over-bag & re-label	B Second package	C Tamper-evident outer pouch	D Rider hand-over	E Seller packing bench
	₹2.60 · 0 · base	₹3.20 · –5	₹0.90 · +1	₹1.20 · +3	₹3.00 · –3
	1.5 bag · 0.4 label · 0.7 labour	0.5 pouch · 1.0 sort · 1.7 drop	0.5 pouch · 0.4 labour	1.0 rider · 0.2 kit	paid to the seller
	Sealed parcel + sachet go into a Valmo mailer; fresh AWB label	Sachet in its own mini-pouch with a child label on the parent AWB	Adhesive "documents enclosed" sleeve outside; never opens the parcel	Rider carries a kit; app flags the stop; "free sample from Meesho, want it?"	High-volume sellers insert at packing; sample weight credited off their slab
SHIP	+12 g, same slab	two handlings	+12 g	0 g · +10 s / drop	credited
BUYER	sealed, tidy	"why two parcels?"	seen before accepting	**best consent moment**	sealed inside
RISK	label mismatch	child pouch lost	peel-off is detected (QR never scanned)	pilferage → kit count	seller stock control
MATCH	flag + pair	flag + pair	flag + pair	run-sheet native	seller stock
	CONTROL LANE	✕ DROPPED	✓ PILOT LANE	✓ PILOT LANE	PHASE 2

Pugh score vs A (+1 / 0 / –1) on cost · sentiment · shipping cost · fraud & damage · matching · scalability. D wins on consent and matching; C on cost and scale; rider capacity is the open question.

Pilot runs C + D, A as control. Unit economics are budgeted at ₹3.00, the worst option, so the case holds even if the cheap ones fail.

Sachet spec for every option (fixes the 39% leak worry): ≤ 20 g · double heat-sealed · 1 m drop + 45 °C heat test · creams/powders before oils · "free sample, not for sale", batch, expiry · **unique QR per sachet** (enables pairing and peel-off detection).

③ MATCHING 500 BULK SAMPLES TO SPECIFIC ORDER IDS · SERVICE BLUEPRINT

flip it: flag the order, don't match the sample

	Order placed	Before dispatch	Hub induction	Insertion	Last mile	After delivery
Buyer	Opted in; sees "may include a free sample"				Receives disclosed sample; may refuse (D)	Scans QR → 3 Qs → ₹15 coupon
Rider				(D) Picks S-07 kit sized to flagged stops	App flags the stop; hands over, taps "given"	
Hub operator			Handheld beeps **"S-07"** → parcel to sample table (A/C) or stays in zone bag (D)	Picks sachet, applies pouch, **pairing scan** (sachet QR + AWB), back to bucket		
Meesho systems	Targeting engine matches order to S-07 → **campaign flag on AWB record**	Quota counter per hub; stops at booked volume	Sort app reads the flag at a scan that already happens	Stores QR ↔ order ID; unpaired sachet = alert	Run sheet + kit count per route	Response joins order ID → cohort report vs holdout

line of visibility

Why it works: the worker never searches 500 sachets for an order. The order **arrives already tagged** at a scan that exists today; the sachet stays generic until the pairing scan gives it an id.

Zone-level (₹9 tier) needs no flag: the hub already buckets by PIN cluster, so every parcel in a targeted bucket gets one sachet until quota. This is the pilot's Day-30 mode.

TRIAL DESIGN · THE METHOD, NOT THE GUESS

randomised, 1 hub, 4 weeks

LANE A	LANE C	LANE D	HOLDOUT
over-bag	outer pouch	rider	no sample
10k	**10k**	**10k**	**10k**

Measured per lane: ₹/insert · insert-error % · NPS Δ vs holdout · return Δ · shipping-cost Δ · response % · rider s/drop · pouch-removal %

Wk 1 · randomise, train → Wk 2-3 · all lanes live · daily NPS & returns → Wk 4 · pick winner

Decision rule: lowest ₹ **per verified response**, if NPS ≥ holdout – 1 and return Δ ≤ +0.1 pp. Hubs may differ (dense urban → C; Tier-3/4 routes → D). 10k/lane detects ±1.3 pp response gaps.

HUB THROUGHPUT CHECK

50,000 parcels/day × 11% = 5,500 inserts × 8 s = 12.2 h

= **1.5 operators / shift** → **₹0.17 labour / insert** · festive peak (3×): add 3 temps or pause

Costs are team estimates from packaging & freight quotes (₹20/kg PTL, ~₹50k FTL, ₹600 operator-shift); Pugh scoring vs option A on six criteria. Throughput assumes 50,000 parcels/day hub, 8 s per insert. All to be validated in Day 0-30 lanes.

Outcome: 60% Cheaper per Launch

PER PRODUCT · PER TRIAL · PER CAMPAIGN · AGAINST TODAY'S BENCHMARKS

SO WHAT For one product launch a brand spends **₹1.62 Cr today and gets 300 answers**. On Meesho it spends **₹65 L and gets 60,000 answers** plus a measured purchase lift: a 60% saving per product. Meesho keeps ₹6.63 a trial; seller and buyer pay nothing.

PER PRODUCT LAUNCH · 60% CHEAPER, 200× FEEDBACK

1 SKU · 5 L homes

	TODAY promoter + home-use test	BHARAT TRIAL NETWORK 5 L trials at ₹13, feedback included
	₹1.62 Cr ₹1.60 Cr sampling (₹32 / contact) + ₹2.4 L HUT (300 × ₹800)	**₹0.65 Cr** ₹65 L, no separate product test needed
Answers	300, metro-skewed	60,000 by segment (12%)
₹ per answer	₹54,000	₹108
Who got it	a location	a spend segment
Purchase signal	district sales, months later	90-day lift vs holdout
First read	6-8 weeks	7 days

VS

~60%	200×	~99.8%	6×
cost per launch · saves ₹97 L	more answers	₹ per answer	faster first read

Saving holds across tiers & promoter cost

₹9 reach	₹13 segment	₹16 closed-loop	promoter ₹25	promoter ₹40
72%	60%	51%	49%	68%

HOW IT IS PAID FOR · PER TRIAL

₹, base tier blend

₹13	₹6.63	₹331 Cr
brand pays / trial	Meesho keeps (51%)	FY28 contribution



51%, budgeted pessimistically: insertion uses the ₹3.00 worst option. If C or D win (₹0.9-1.2), contribution rises to **₹8.4-8.7 (65-67%)**. Inbound is brand-funded.

BRAND ROI PER CAMPAIGN

5 L trials · first-year view

Per campaign	Promoter	BTN
Spend	₹1.62 Cr	₹65 L
Incremental conversion (assumed)	3% untargeted	6% targeted
New buyers	15,000	30,000
Yr-1 gross margin / buyer (4 × ₹120 × 50%)	₹240	₹240

₹ PER NEW BUYER

Promoter	₹1,080
BTN	₹217

YEAR-1 ROI · DASHED LINE = BREAK-EVEN (1×)

Promoter	0.22×
BTN	1.11×

5×	Pays back
cheaper per new buyer	inside year 1, with holdout proof

Break-even conversion: BTN needs **5.4%**; promoter sampling needs **13.5%**, above most measured evidence. Even at 3%, BTN halves ₹ per buyer.

NORTH-STAR METRIC & KPI TREE

what we optimise · what we never trade away

NORTH STAR

Verified answers delivered to brands / week

value to brand (learning) × value to buyer (free trial) in one number

REACH	RESPONSE	BRAND VALUE	REVENUE
Opt-in rate **50%**	Scan rate	90-day lift	Trials × price Blend
Parcels with trial **11%**	Completion	₹ / answer **₹108**	**₹13** Contribution
Hubs live	Verified **12%**	Rebooking **≥ 60%**	**51%**

Counter-metrics, never traded away:

NPS Δ vs holdout | return Δ | 30-day opt-out | hub sort SLA | complaints / 10k

Biggest lever: at the FY28 run-rate, 9.6 Mn trials a week × 12% = **1.15 Mn answers a week**. +1 pp of response adds ~96k answers at zero extra trials, so response quality is optimised first.

SUCCESS RATIO · BENCHMARKED AGAINST MEESHO

holdout = today

Metric ▲ up · ▼ down is good	Benchmark today	Target	Kill line
▲ Verified response rate	0% (promoter) · HUT n = 300	12%	< 6%
▲ Sample → purchase lift	5-25% claimed, unmeasured	+6 pp	not signif.
▲ Buyer NPS Δ	Meesho holdout parcels	≥ 0	< −2
▼ Return-rate Δ	Meesho holdout parcels	≤ +0.1 pp	> +0.3 pp
▼ 30-day opt-out rate	survey: 23% "must have"	< 10%	> 25%
▼ Insert cost	₹3.00 budgeted	≤ ₹1.20	> ₹3.00
• Hub sort SLA	Valmo baseline	no change	> 1% late
▲ Brand rebooking	-	3 of 5	< 2 of 5

Why holdouts: Meesho doesn't publish insert or survey metrics, so the cleanest "current metric" is its own parcels without a sample: same hub, segment and week.

WHY IT FITS THE BRIEF

new · zero commission · affordability

01 · Genuinely new. New payer (brands that may never sell on Meesho), new budget (BTL; e-com gets ₹0 today), new product (consented feedback, not an impression). No auction, so seller CAC doesn't rise.

02 · Zero commission intact. Seller pays ₹0 and isn't a party. **Test:** delete every seller from the model and revenue is unchanged.

03 · Affordability improved. The buyer gets a free product + ₹15 off; ₹0.73 of margin per parcel can flow into the ₹46.3 shipping cost that sets prices.

Why only Meesho: the one player that can both **hand a product to a chosen Bharat household** and **hear back from her** (benchmark, slide 08).

15 IDEAS SCREENED · 12 KILLED, FOR EXAMPLE

× seller subscription: a 12% commission renamed | × demand-data: ₹1,600 Cr MR market | × kirana B2B: Kirana Club bought | × doorstep verification: Delhivery-Ecom | × paid MSME on-ramp: GST 34/2023

Promoter ₹32/contact = midpoint of ₹25-40; HUT ₹800/respondent and 3%/6% conversion are assumptions (Appendix). Gross margin/buyer: 4 packs × ₹120 × 50%. Benchmarks read against matched holdouts from Meesho's own parcels.

Business Case: Who Pays & How It Scales

PAYER SEGMENTS · BENCHMARKING VS EXISTING SAMPLING MODELS · 5-YEAR P&L · PHASED ROLLOUT

SO WHAT Three kinds of brands pay, from national FMCG to a ₹0.9 L regional SME ticket. No existing sampling model both **puts the product in a chosen hand and hears back** at Bharat scale. It needs **₹19 Cr at peak**, pays back by **month 13**, and holds ~1% of NMV from FY29.

WHO PAYS · THREE BRAND SEGMENTS

payer segmentation · FY28 trial mix

National FMCG
launch teams, listed HPC & food

₹16 closed-loop tier

- ✓ 20+ launches a year
- ✓ Has promoters, lacks **proof**
- ✓ Buys via its BTL agency

Evidence: HUL alone spent ₹6,199 Cr on A&P in FY25

D2C & challenger
beauty, wellness, personal care

₹13 segment tier

- ✓ No Tier 3-4 distribution
- ✓ Needs **who converts**
- ✓ Self-serve console

Evidence: launches up 1.8×, only 4% reach 1% penetration (NIQ)

Regional & SME
e.g. a Kanpur hair-oil maker

₹9 reach tier · from ₹0.9 L

- ✓ Promoters unaffordable beyond home district
- ✓ Serves **small players**

Evidence: our brand interview: "₹13 mein … pilot ka budget ban jayega"

FY28 TRIAL MIX → BLENDED PRICE

FMCG 30% × ₹16 | D2C 45% × ₹13 | SME 25% × ₹9 | **₹12.9** ≈ ₹13 blended

Small players served: a 10,000-trial SME campaign at ₹9 costs ₹0.9 L, less than one month of a single promoter team, and it comes with the answers.

BENCHMARKING · WHO ELSE PUTS A PRODUCT IN HAND, AND HEARS BACK?

India & global sampling models

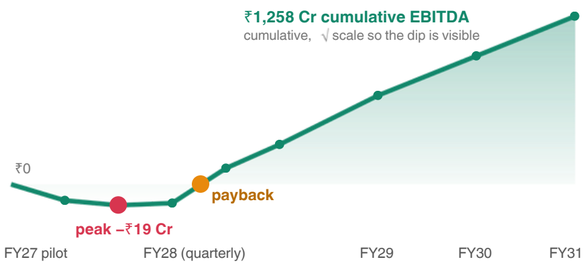
Capability	BTL promoter agency	Free minis in own orders	Home-use test agency	Amazon Sampling (US)	Sampler, Peekage (apps)	Meesho BTN
Physical product in hand	●	●	●	●	●	●
Chooses the household	○	◑ own buyers only	● recruited	● purchase history	● profile	● **spend segment**
Hears back (response)	○	○	● n ≈ 300	◑ reviews	●	● **12%**
Purchase proof vs holdout	○	◑ own sales	○	◑ own sales	◑	● **90-day**
Reaches Tier 3-4 at scale	◑ costly	○ urban	○ metro	○ not India	○ not India	● **264 Mn buyers**
Opt-in, disclosed	◑	◑	●	○ surprise	●	●
Capability score / 6	**2.0**	**2.5**	**4.0**	**3.0**	**4.5**	**6.0**
Cost per contact	₹25-40	₹2-5	₹800	~₹170	premium	**₹9-16**
What we borrow	the trial habit & BTL budget line	no extra trip	structured 3-question read	targeting on purchase history	reward for answering	**all five, at Bharat scale**
What we avoid	no data	no new buyers	tiny, slow n	**surprise parcels** (it closed)	urban-only panel	-

Full circle = 1, half = 0.5, empty = 0. Amazon ≈ $2/sample, 25k minimum. Agency & HUT costs from our build-up and brand interview; app pricing not public.

FIVE-YEAR BUSINESS CASE · P&L AND PROFIT CURVE

₹ Cr · FY = Apr-Mar · pilot starts Oct 2026

₹ Cr	FY27	FY28	FY29	FY30	FY31
Trials delivered (Mn)	2	235	616	770	963
Blended price (₹)	9	13	13	13.5	14
Revenue	**2**	**306**	**801**	**1,040**	**1,348**
Contribution (51-53%)	1	156	408	541	715
– Agency & sales commission (6%)	0	18	48	62	81
– Fixed: tech, team, compliance	12	55	80	95	110
EBITDA	**–12**	**82**	**280**	**383**	**524**
Cumulative	–12	71	351	734	1,258
% of that year's NMV	0.00%	0.47%	**0.99%**	**1.02%**	**1.06%**
progress to the 1% target					



₹19 Cr peak investment

Month 10 operating break-even (Q2 FY28)

Month 13 cumulative payback (Q3 FY28)

Trials = parcels × 11% (FY28 ramps 10 → 30 → 70 → 125 Mn a quarter). Price rises to ₹14 by FY31 as 90-day proof matures. Fixed FY28: tech & data ₹20 Cr, team ₹20 Cr, hub set-up ₹8 Cr, trust & compliance ₹7 Cr. NMV grows 25% a year from ₹41,600 Cr (FY26).

Downside case (order-level matching fails, every trial sells at ₹9): contribution falls to ₹2.63 a trial, FY28 EBITDA ≈ –₹6 Cr, FY29 ≈ +₹49 Cr: **still profitable, payback slips into FY29**. The pilot's Day-60 gate tests exactly this.

PHASED CLUSTER EXPANSION

where Meesho's Tier 2-4 buyers are densest first

FY27 - FY29



1. **Pilot: Eastern UP & Bihar** Q3 FY27
   Lucknow → Patna, Varanasi · 3 hubs · BPC only
2. **Hindi belt** FY28 H1
   Rest of UP, MP, Rajasthan, Jharkhand · 60 hubs · + perfume
3. **West & South Tier 2-4** FY28 H2
   Maharashtra, Gujarat, Karnataka, Telangana · all hubs · + home care · vernacular survey
4. **Pan-India + new categories** FY29
   East & North-East · + edible, wellness · seller-bench insertion

Why this order: start where Meesho's parcels are densest and brand coverage is thinnest, prove it in Hindi first, then add languages and categories once the 3-question survey and the leak-proof formats are proven.

3 hubs 0.3 Mn trials → **60 hubs** 40 Mn → **all hubs** 195 Mn → **+ categories** 616 Mn

P&L built from the same inputs as slides 04-07 (Appendix). Commission assumes half of revenue sold via agencies at 12%. Fixed-cost lines are team estimates. Amazon Product Sampling terms from public reporting (2019-20).

What Is Still Unsolved

NAMED GAPS, PRICED · RISKS · GUARDRAILS FOR BUYER PRICES, SMALL SELLERS AND TRUST



SO WHAT Five things are not yet proven. Two of them alone put **~₹410 Cr of the ₹650 Cr at stake**, which is why the ₹46 L pilot measures them first and kills the idea if they fail. Buyer trust, not scan rate, is the kill-switch.

WHAT IS STILL UNSOLVED, AND WHAT SOLVING IT IS WORTH

named · priced · each tied to a pilot gate

1 Order-level matching at peak

₹200 Cr

₹4 × 500 Mn trials

Why open: pairing scan adds ~8 s; untested at 3× festive volume

Fallback: zone-level targeting, priced at ₹9

Day 60 · error ≤ 2%, ≤ 8 s

2 Cheapest packing buyers accept

₹50 Cr

per ₹1 saved per insert

Why open: four options from ₹0.9 to ₹3.2; buyer sentiment unknown

Fallback: budget stays at ₹3.00 (worst case)

Day 30 · lanes A / C / D

3 Edible samples

₹305 Cr

edible = 47% of the pool

Why open: most wanted (73%) but FSSAI labelling, shelf-life, heat in transit

Fallback: BPC, perfume, home care only

Month 6 · FSSAI label sign-off

4 Return-rate direction

₹3.5 Cr

per 0.1 pp avoided

Why open: a leak can raise returns, a welcome gift can lower them; no data yet

Fallback: reserve ₹0.35 / trial (+0.5 pp)

Day 30-60 · holdout delta

5 True response rate

Price power

–8% ₹/answer per +1 pp

Why open: 42% say "definitely"; the real say-do gap is unknown

Fallback: at 6%, ₹/answer doubles to ₹217, still 99% below today

Day 30 · kill if < 6%

IF GAPS 1 AND 3 BOTH STAY UNSOLVED, ₹650 CR BECOMES ₹240 CR (0.37% NMV)

₹240 Cr secured	₹105 Cr gap 1	₹305 Cr gap 3 · edible

Gap 1 is worth ₹200 Cr alone, but only ₹105 Cr once edible is already out, so ₹410 Cr is at stake in total, not ₹505 Cr.

~890×
₹410 Cr at stake ÷ ₹46 L pilot. Pilot settles gaps 1, 2, 4, 5

DECIDED, NOT GAPS

- **Buyer incentive?** Meesho pays, ₹0.72 / trial
- **Non-responders?** brand pays per delivered trial
- **Packing first?** C + D, A as control
- **Lead category?** beauty & personal care
- **Where?** Eastern UP & Bihar

RISK HEAT MAP

probability × impact · with mitigation

IMPACT ↓ / PROBABILITY →	LOW		HIGH
HIGH	R6 Regulatory	R1 Leak → return R2 "How did they know?" R7 No rebooking	
	R9 Amazon / Flipkart copy	R3 Response < 6%	R4 Hub congestion at festive peak
LOW		R8 Rider pilferage	R5 Agencies defend clients

- R1 one insert, leak-tested, outside the carton
- R2 opt-in + disclosure, cohort-only data
- R4 per-hub caps, festive blackout
- R7 Day-90 proof before any scale
- R3 relevance-first, ₹15 coupon, 20-s survey
- R5 sell through agencies at 10-15%
- R6 category exclusions from day 1
- R8 per-route kit count, unpaired alert
- R9 moat = Tier 2-4 parcel base + a consented panel, not the mechanic

GUARDRAILS · BUYER PRICES, SMALL SELLERS, TRUST

non-negotiables

BUYER PRICES

- ✓ Not one paisa added to any product price
- ✓ Coupon cuts her next basket by ₹15
- ✓ **₹0.73 per parcel** free for shipping subsidy
- ✓ No auction, so seller CAC doesn't rise

SMALL SELLERS

- ✓ Seller pays ₹0 and isn't a party
- ✓ Sample weight never billed to his slab
- ✓ No ranking or visibility impact
- ✓ Phase 2: optional ₹3 / parcel (+1.9% of sales)

TRUST & PRIVACY

- ✓ Opt-in only; max 1 sample a month
- ✓ Brands see cohorts ≥ 5,000, never PII
- ✓ Never a competitor of what she bought
- ✓ Rating < 3.0 auto-pauses a campaign

OFF **KILL-SWITCH: buyer trust, not scan rate.** Any hub with NPS below holdout – 2 or return Δ above +0.3 pp stops inserting the same day.

RETURN ORDERS · BOTH DIRECTIONS

modelled before the pilot

↑ Could raise returns

Leak stains the order: 0.2% leak × 50% damaging = **+0.10 pp**. Outside pouch looks tampered: tracked by reason code.

↓ Could lower returns

49% of non-metro buyers say a sample raises trust. A gift at the door may cut COD refusals: not counted.

RETURN-RATE Δ VS HOLDOUT · LOG SCALE, PP

+0.10 | +0.30 | +0.50 | +10

EXPECTED	KILL LINE	RESERVE	BREAK-EVEN
₹0.07 / trial	hub stops	₹0.35 / trial	₹6.98 ÷ ₹70

Read: money is never the constraint; a sample must cause 1 extra return in 10 parcels to lose money. **The kill line protects buyer trust.** Measured on sampled vs holdout parcels, same hub & week, with a "sample" reason code.

COMPLIANCE CHECKLIST

what the law asks · how we comply

Rule	Our design	When
Cosmetics Rules, 2020	Licensed brands only; "free sample, not for sale", batch & expiry on every sachet	Day 1
FSSAI labelling	Edible only after full-label & shelf-life sign-off	Phase 2
Legal Metrology	Mandatory declarations printed on pack	Day 1
DPDP Act, 2023	Explicit opt-in, purpose-limited, deletion on opt-out; cohorts ≥ 5,000, never PII	Day 1
Consumer Protection (E-com)	Disclosed at checkout and on the parcel; "sent by Meesho"; no dark patterns	Day 1
IMS Act	No infant-food samples; baby care limited to skin & hygiene	Phase 2
Never sampled	Medicines, alcohol, tobacco, or a rival of what she just bought	Never

Return cost ≈ 1.5× forward logistics (₹46.3/order, Meesho FY26). Leak rate (0.2%) and damage share (50%) are team assumptions. Heat-map placements are team judgements, revisited at each pilot gate.

Roadmap: 90 Days to Prove It

30 / 60 / 90 PILOT WITH KILL GATES · OKRS · NOW / NEXT / LATER

SO WHAT ₹46 lakh and 90 days settle the unsolved questions in the order that matters: buyer trust first, then the packing and matching mechanics, then whether brands pay again. Net ₹24 L after brands pay a 50% pilot rate.

30 / 60 / 90 PILOT · HYPOTHESIS-DRIVEN, WITH THE NUMBER THAT KILLS IT AT EACH GATE

Oct-Dec 2026 · Eastern UP & Bihar · total ₹46 L

WEEK –4 → 0 · SET UP

- Sign 2 BPC brands at a **50% pilot rate** (₹6.50/trial) Opt-in + checkout disclosure live for Lucknow PINs
- AWB campaign flag + pairing scan in the sort app
- QR → 3 questions → coupon service
- "Free sample, not for sale" labels · DPDP consent text
- Holdout randomised and locked before day 0

✓ READY · contracts, build, consent

DAY 0 - 30 · PROVE THE BUYER & PACKING

WE BELIEVE opted-in buyers welcome a disclosed sample, and a ₹1 insert is liked as much as a ₹2.60 one.

SCOPE 1 Valmo hub · 2 brands · 40k parcels · lanes A / C / D + holdout · zone targeting

MEASURE NPS Δ · return Δ · opt-out · ₹/insert · response % · rider s/drop

✕ KILL IF NPS < holdout – 2 · return Δ > +0.3 pp · response < 6%

DAY 31 - 60 · PROVE TARGETING & MATCHING

WE BELIEVE spend segments answer ≥ 1.5× better than zone targeting, and flag-the-order matching holds ≤ 2% error.

SCOPE 3 hubs (+ Patna, Varanasi) · 5 brands · 3 L trials · price tiers ₹9 / ₹13 / ₹16

MEASURE response by segment · matching error · s/insert · willingness to pay by tier

✕ KILL IF segment < 1.5× zone · matching error > 2% · insert > ₹3

DAY 61 - 90 · PROVE THE PROOF

WE BELIEVE the 90-day purchase lift is real and measurable, and brands pay full price to get it again.

SCOPE 90-day re-survey + purchase data on cohort 1 vs matched holdout · dashboard v1 · rebooking ask at ₹13

MEASURE incremental lift · ₹ per new buyer · rebooking rate

✕ KILL IF no significant lift · < 2 of 5 brands rebook at ≥ ₹13

	WEEK –4 → 0 · SET UP	DAY 0 - 30 · PROVE THE BUYER & PACKING	DAY 31 - 60 · PROVE TARGETING & MATCHING	DAY 61 - 90 · PROVE THE PROOF
Tech & data	AWB flag · pairing scan · QR service	dashboard v0 · daily NPS / returns	segment builder · price tiers	dashboard v1 · lift model
Hub ops	SOPs · racks · training · kits	lanes A / C / D at Lucknow	+ Patna, Varanasi · winner per hub	steady state · festive-peak plan
Brand sales	2 pilot MoUs at ₹6.50	weekly read-outs to brands	+3 brands · tier pricing	rebooking ask at ₹13
Research & legal	labels · DPDP text · randomisation	holdout NPS & return deltas	segment response analysis	90-day re-survey · lift read

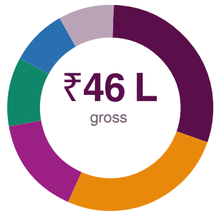
DAY-90 DECISION

- **GO** · all three gates pass → 15 hubs in Q1 FY28, console build starts
- **PIVOT** · buyers happy, lift unproven → sell ₹9 reach tier only (~₹446 Cr)
- **STOP** · trust gate fails → exit at ₹24 L net, no scale capex spent

PILOT OKRS & THE ₹46 L

what success means, what it costs

- **O1** Buyers welcome it. **NPS Δ ≥ 0 · opt-out < 10% · return Δ ≤ +0.1 pp**
- **O2** The loop works. **verified response ≥ 12% · matching error ≤ 2% · insert ≤ ₹1.20**
- **O3** Brands pay again. **3 of 5 rebook at ≥ ₹13 · significant 90-day lift in ≥ 2 campaigns**



Tech: flag, pairing scan, QR, dashboard	14
Hub ops: operators, pouches, kits, riders	12
Programme team (PM + ops, 3 months)	7
Legal & compliance (labels, DPDP)	5
Holdout re-survey & analysis	4
Buyer coupons + contingency	4

– ₹22 L brand pilot fees = ₹24 L net to Meesho

SCALE · NOW / NEXT / LATER

1% NMV ≈ 1 in 9 parcels × ₹13

NOW · Q3 FY27

Pilot: BPC, 3 hubs, C + D packing, segments, holdouts. Go / no-go at day 90.

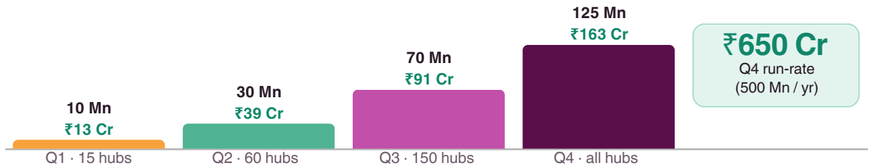
NEXT · FY28

All Valmo hubs · rider lane on Tier 3-4 · self-serve console · 2 agencies · + perfume, home care

LATER · FY29+

Edible (post-FSSAI) · seller-bench insertion (₹3/parcel) · concept tests · leg-two reach

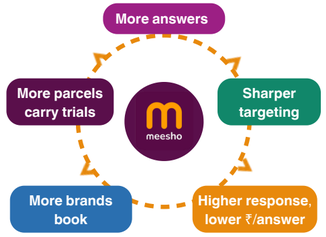
FY28 RAMP · TRIALS PER QUARTER (MN) AND REVENUE



Stated plainly: FY28 books ~235 Mn trials ≈ **₹305 Cr** and exits at a ₹650 Cr run-rate; **FY29 full year ≈ ₹800 Cr ≈ 1% of FY29 NMV**.

10× AND LONG-TERM THINKING

go-to-market · moat · vision



The moat compounds. Each lap of the flywheel makes the next campaign cheaper. The mechanic is copyable; **the Tier 2-4 audience and its consent are not.**

Go-to-market. Beachhead: D2C & mid-size hair-oil, skin-care and fragrance brands entering Tier 2-4. Sell via 2 BTL agencies (10-15%), then a self-serve console.



The 10× version: the Bharat Trial Panel. 165 Mn opted-in households become India's largest always-on consumer panel. Brands test 3 pack / price variants with 10k homes each **before** launch, a Tier-3 panel India's ₹1,600 Cr research industry has never had.

Leg two (secondary): brands that learn which segment converts then buy targeted reach on Meesho. Upside not counted in the ₹650 Cr.

Pilot geography: Lucknow → Patna, Varanasi (Eastern UP & Bihar). FY28 ramp assumes hub roll-out 15 → 60 → 150 → all; FY29 parcels 5.6 Bn at 25% growth. Pilot fees: 3.4 L trials × ₹6.50.

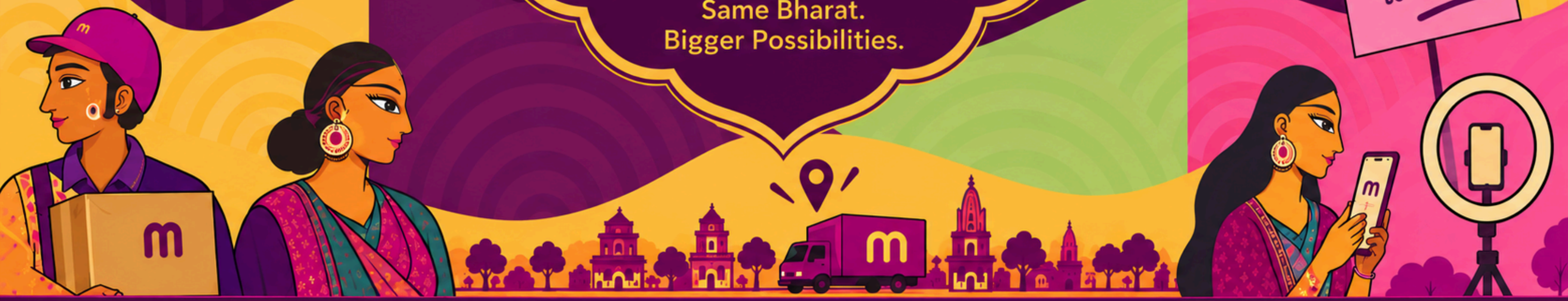
meesho DICE CHALLENGE | SEASON 3

meesho
Bharat Buys Bigger

THANK YOU

FOR LISTENING

Same Bharat.
Bigger Possibilities.



- ***Prototype***
- ***Survey Responses***
- ***Call Recordings***

meesho SEASON 3 DICE CHALLENGE

Appendix

ASSUMPTION REGISTER · SOURCES · PRIMARY RESEARCH LINKS

NOTE Every number in this deck is either **sourced**, **from our own primary research**, or a **labelled assumption with the pilot gate that tests it.** Low-confidence assumptions are exactly the pilot's kill lines.

ASSUMPTION REGISTER · EVERY NUMBER ON THE DECK, ITS BASIS, AND HOW THE PILOT TESTS IT

Show the working

Assumption	Value	Basis / source	Confidence · test
MEESHO BASELINE			
FY26 NMV	₹41,600 Cr	Contribution ₹2,060 Cr = 4.95% of NMV (FY26 annual report)	HIGH filed
NMV growth to FY28	25% CAGR	Management guidance → FY28 NMV ≈ ₹65,000 Cr; 1% = ₹650 Cr	MED guidance
Orders · ATU · NMV/order	2.67 Bn · 264 Mn · ₹156	FY26 filings → 10.1 orders / user / yr; ₹1,580 annual spend	HIGH filed
FY28 parcels	4.5 Bn	Orders grow with NMV at constant ₹/order	MED
DEMAND-SIDE SIZING			
Category sales (7)	₹14.9 lakh Cr	Redseer (BPC), BW (fragrance), IMARC/IBEF (packaged food $129 Bn, snacks, biscuits, confectionery, nutra, baby), Euromonitor (home)	HIGH secondary
A&P as % of sales	4-15%	HUL 9.6%, Marico 11.2%, Emami ~20%, Britannia 3.1%, Tata Consumer 7.2%, Jyothy 8.3%, Zydus Wellness 15.4%; deo industry 7-8%	HIGH filings
Share of A&P behind launches	15%	Launches = 3-7% of sales (Nestlé India 7%, Dabur 3-5%, Kantar GB <10%) × 2-3× ad intensity at launch	MED brand calls
Sampling + testing share of launch spend	20-25%	DTC brands spend ~15% of all marketing on sampling; launches lean harder on trial; +~5% consumer testing	MED brand calls
Expansion trial, existing brands	3% of A&P	Brands entering new households / regions; a fifth of the DTC sampling benchmark	LOW brand calls
Non-metro share (SAM)	55%	Rural = 38% of FMCG sales (NIQ 2025) + Tier-2/3 towns	MED
Meesho share of SAM (SOM)	15% → ₹608 Cr	Analog: Meesho holds ~16% of e-com retail media	LOW Day-90 rebook
PRODUCT & UNIT ECONOMICS			
Opt-in rate	50%	Survey: 79% positive; halved for caution	MED Day 30
Verified response rate	12%	Survey: 42% "definitely" × 0.3 say-do discount	LOW Day 30
Coupon redemption	40% of ₹15	→ ₹0.72 / trial, Meesho-funded	MED Day 60
Insertion cost	₹0.9-3.2	Pouch, mailer, label, labour quotes; ₹0.17 labour from throughput math	MED Day 30 lanes
Return cost · expected Δ	₹70 · +0.1 pp	~1.5× ₹46.3 forward logistics; 0.2% leak × 50% damaging	LOW holdout
Promoter cost per contact	₹25-40	Our 5-promoter × 10-day cost build-up (₹15 time-only) + brand interview (Tier-3 ₹28-32)	HIGH primary
Home-use test cost	₹800 / resp.	Agency rate-card estimate for a 300-person HUT	MED brand calls
Opted-in households · trials each	165 Mn · 3 / yr	331 Mn FY28 ATU × 50%; cap of 1 sample a month	MED Day 60
Promoter-day cost	₹3,000	₹1.5 L ÷ 50 promoter-days (our cost build-up)	HIGH primary
Inbound freight	₹0.25 / sample	~₹50k FTL for 6 t + ₹0.15 hub handling	MED quotes
Gross margin per new buyer	₹240 / yr	4 full-size packs × ₹120 × 50% margin	MED brand data
Incremental conversion	6% vs 3%	Industry 5-25% claimed (survey-based); conservative	LOW Day 90

SECONDARY SOURCES

India & global

1. Redseer: Beauty Blitz 2030: India BPC $23 Bn FY25, 12% CAGR · redseer.com
2. BW Businessworld: India perfume & deo ~₹10,000 Cr (perfume ₹4,500, deo ₹5,500)
3. IMARC: India snacks ₹50,590 Cr; confectionery ₹39,871 Cr; nutraceuticals $8.93 Bn; baby care $4.82 Bn (2025)
4. IBEF: biscuits, cookies & crackers ₹1,16,706 Cr (2025)
5. Euromonitor: India home care retail value ₹666 bn (2025)
6. NielsenIQ India: FMCG launches 1.8× (yr to May 2025); 4% reach 1% penetration; rural = 38% of FMCG (2025)
7. FY25 A&P (afaqs, Storyboard18, company results): HUL ~9.6%, Marico 11.2%, Emami ~20%, Britannia 3.1%, Tata Consumer 7.2%, Jyothy 8.3%, Zydus Wellness 15.4%; Fogg/Vini 23% S&D (Business Today)
8. Innovation share of sales: Nestlé India ~7% (Q3 FY25 release), Dabur NPD 3-5%, Kantar GB launches <10% (2020)
9. Meesho FY26 annual report & investor presentation: NMV, orders, ATU, contribution, Valmo share
10. WiFi Talents sampling statistics: DTC brands ~15% of marketing on sampling · In-Kluso Ground: "In-store sampling is a $2 Bn channel and nobody agrees how to measure it"
11. International Journal of Advertising (1992): "The effect of product sampling on product trial, purchase and conversion"
12. Amazon Product Sampling (2019-20), Peekage, Sampler: sampling pricing & closed-loop models
13. DPDP Act 2023 & Rules; Drugs & Cosmetics Rules; FSSAI labelling regulations; Legal Metrology

GLOSSARY

A&P: advertising & promotion spend
BTL: below-the-line (sampling, activation)
HUT: home-use product test
S&T: sampling & testing spend
NMV: net merchandise value
ATU: annual transacting users
TAM/SAM/SOM: total / serviceable / obtainable
CPT: cost per (delivered) trial
AWB: airway bill (parcel ID)
PTL / FTL: part / full truckload
Holdout: matched parcels with no sample
pp: percentage points

PRIMARY RESEARCH & PROTOTYPE

links

Survey responses (n = 62): Google Sheet ↗ · 10 questions · Sep 2026

Call recordings (4 interviews): Drive folder ↗ : 2 buyers, 1 brand sales rep, 1 seller

Clickable prototype: buyer opt-in → sample → 3 questions → coupon; brand console & sizing calculator Prototype ↗

Calculation trail: every figure on slides 02-10 reproduces from the register on the left; the three sizing routes, the waterfall and the per-product saving use only these inputs.